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popular board games has been virtually recreated into a mega-sized masterpiece as Google and Hasbro teamed up to launch *Monopoly City Streets*. The game allows users to compete in a live, worldwide version of the popular game, creating the biggest Monopoly tournament ever played. And yes, you can theoretically buy any street in the world! However within the first few days of launch (on September 9) there were hardly any streets available for us to buy. A new player will start off with a whopping three million Monopoly dollars – it seems like inflation has caught on in the board games too. With this, you can initially buy a street or make an offer to a street owner to buy it off him. The huge money to start off obviously means that the streets will cost a lot too: Downing Street in the UK will cost 231,000 Monopoly Dollars, while Pennsylvania Avenue will cost 2 million. Pedder Road an upmarket Mumbai road was last valued at 400,000. Yikes! Of course, you can always offset those prices by collecting rent from hotels, football stadiums, skyscrapers, castles, etc.

There is a bit of a weird rule thrown in, though, where if someone makes you an offer and you don't reply within seven days, the offer is automatically accepted no matter how low it is. So potentially, you will have to log in every day and if someone spams you with a lot of offers, you might just stand to lose your property. Hopefully, there will be a fix or some workaround for this. The interface too is buggy, but thousands are already addicted. So go ahead and join the game that has turned the globe into one giant game board!

Chrome 3 in one year

On September 2, Google Chrome finished a whole year

since it launched to the world in that unexpected comic book format. To celebrate the occasion – albeit two weeks late – Google has unveiled the new stable version of their browser, Chrome 3.0. The version numbers seem to be ticking by faster than we can report them, with Chrome 2.0 being launched just four months ago; still, who's complaining?

According to StatsCounter, the browser already has 7.39 per cent of the market share in India, making it a force to reckon with. So what does the new version have in store for us? Google Chrome Product Manager Anthony Laforge wrote a long post on the official blog about the same, and here are the salient points: Faster browsing: This new release of Google Chrome is faster than ever, improving by more than 150 per cent in Javascript performance since the very first beta, and by more than 25 per cent since the most recent stable release. New Tab Page: The speed-dial on the New Tab page of Google Chrome has been one of its most popular features and now it's more customisable too. You can now rearrange thumbnails of your most-visited websites by simply clicking and dragging your mouse.

Additionally, you can pin thumbnails to a spot so they don't disappear even if your browsing habits change. What's more, you can hide parts of the page you don't want to see, or even opt for a simple list view of all your most visited web sites. Omnibox gets icons: The



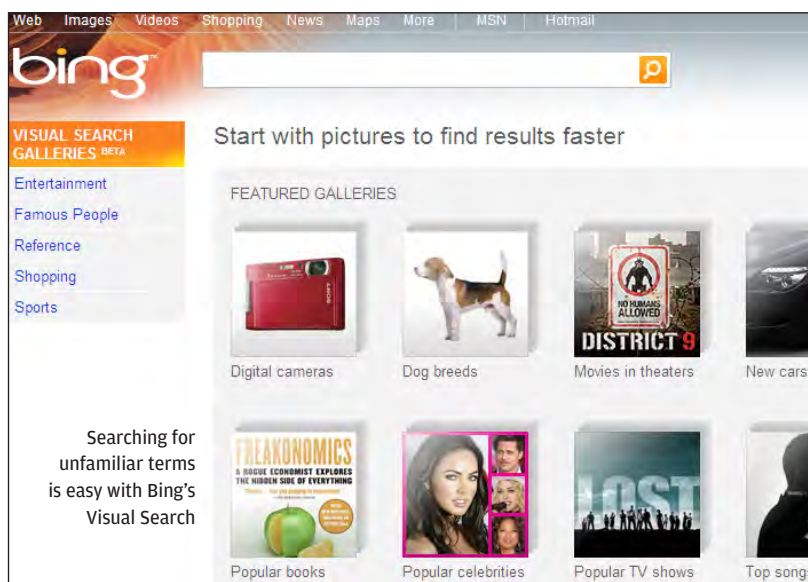
For more Bing's visual search feature, go to www.thinkdigit.com/d/bing

address-cum-search bar 'Omnibox' of Google Chrome has gotten a much-needed tweak to help users distinguish a search result from a Wiki page and a site you entered from a bookmark in its drop-down menu. The solution? A simple little icon at the start of the URL. The one big disappointment, of course, is the lack of extensions in this new release. Looks like Google still has some creases to iron out.

Bing goes visual

Microsoft has launched a new feature in Bing that couldn't have come at a better time. We were trying hard to remember the name of a movie about an African-American cop who is

Silverlight installed. What you are presented with first is a list of different categories such as movies, cars and US presidents. In our case, we went for 'Greatest Movies' and were taken to the next page. Here, we were shown a grid of 9-columned thumbnails of various movie posters. It's got a nice CoverFlow kind of feel to it and feels very Apple in most ways. The scroll bar, funnily, starts at the bottom and you have to scroll upwards, where the columns are fading into. Scrolling upwards, felt a bit like scrolling albums on HTC's TouchFLO interface or Win+Tabbing through Windows Aero, where you can see the current item clearly and check



sent to investigate a murder in a racist town, but couldn't even remember who the actor was. Visual Search basically puts up a whole bunch of images related to different categories, making it easy for you to locate those 'It's on the tip of my tongue' things that you just can't recall. The feature has not been activated for Indian users yet, but if you just change your location to US (top right corner), you will be able to access it for now at www.bing.com/visualsearch. And yes, make sure you have

out obscured previews of the upcoming items. Pretty soon, we found what we were looking for: *In The Heat Of The Night*. Hovering the cursor over it and at the top of the page – under the search bar – gave the related info: name, genre, rating and release date. One click and the regular search results page for the movie opened up. Pretty impressive. The same kind of visual search is possible for various other things, such as products search, books and cars. **d**



For more on the browser, go to www.thinkdigit.com/d/21123